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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture

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நெல் ஆராய்ச்சி அபிவிருத்தி நிறுவனம் - பதலகொட
Rice Research and Development Institute (RRDI) - Bathalagoda

Wet-bed method

Nursery

Nursery location

- Develop in a part of the same field that crops will be grown.
    - total seed bed area is about 1/10 of the area to be transplanted.
    - nursery sites should not be in a shady place

Construction of the seed bed

- Soil is well **puddled and leveled** before nursery establishment.
- Drainage canals are constructed between seed beds for proper water management.
- Decomposed organic manure and **basal inorganic fertilizer** dressing is added
    - facilitates easy uprooting of seedlings.
    - increases seedling vigor.

Nursery maintenance

- Maintained in a **moist** condition for about **5 days**.
    - free from weeds, pests and diseases.
    - without nutrient deficiencies.

Seed Paddy

Requirement

- About 50 kg per Ha.
- Seed rate is adjusted for small grain varieties.

Seed preparation

- Soaked for a minimum of 24 hours (using clean water).
- Incubated for about 48 hours (in a warm dry place).

Nursery establishment

- Nursery is drained well before seed sowing.
- Pre-germinated seeds are broadcasted uniformly over the seed bed.
- Once the seedlings are established,
    -
        - nursery is impounded with water.
        - water level is raised gradually.
- Seedlings are kept for about **12-21 days** (depending on the age class of the variety).

Wet-bed nurseries assure rapid seedling growth and allow easy uprooting of seedlings.